MCP

Title:
D and Me

Author:
Steve DuBois

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Publication Date: December 1, 2024

Published by
MUSHROOM CLOUD PRESS
An imprint of Rainbow Skull LLC
Made in the USA

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[MACY is a college student. D is her roommate. At the opening, Macy is entering their shared apartment with a bag of groceries in each arm. D is on the couch in front of a gaming console.]

D: Behold! Our conquering hero returns. In this case, from the supermarket. What up, roomate?

M: Hey, D.

D: Need a hand with those?

M: That'd be good, thanks.

[The two of them load the groceries into cabinets and the refrigerator.]

D: So. Macy. We still on for video games tonight?

M: Oh! That! Yeah. Uh…

D: The new expansion for *Fashion Police* just dropped. *Hipster Hysteria!* An entire community awash in skinny jeans and horn-rimmed glasses! Fashion crimes as far as the eye can see! Where is justice, Macy? Where. Is. Justice???

M: Actually, I was planning on going out. Trivia night at Mulligan's with some friends from Sociology class.

D: Ah.

M: You can come.

D: It's not like you could leave me behind. *[Pause]* So…I guess this is the "girl gamer" thing again?

M: What do you mean?

D: A whole society of online bros, shaming and harassing every girl gamer they see.

M: Well…yeah, but…

D: And they've gotten into your head, haven't they? Because that's the thing, Macy. We can ward off whatever life throws at us–misogyny, cruelty, all of it–when it's out in the open. But it's when the bad guys get inside your head—when they get you feeling guilty, when they get you making excuses to do what *they* want, not what *you* want—that's when they do real damage.

M: I…I mean…

D: Look at me, Macy. Are you sure you really want to go out tonight? Or are you letting a bunch of pimply-faced twerps chase you away from what you love?

M: Well, I mean…I'm not…I guess I'm not *absolutely* sure, but…well. When you put it that way…all right.

D: To phooey with trivia night! Mount up, Officer Macy. Time to hit the virtual streets and bust us some fashion offenders!

M: To the console!

D: Attagirl!

[SCENE]

M: Jared asked me out!

D: Ooh.

M: God, D, a little more enthusiasm, wouldya? Jared asked me out! He's cute! He's nice!

D: He acts nice.

M: D, acting nice is what being nice *is!*

D: No, acting nice is how you get away with not being nice later. You don't need to worry about a dude who's openly a jerk. You know what to expect. It's the ones who act nice who you need to watch.

M: Oh, c'mon, D.

D: Think about it, Macy. If a guy's a superpredator, what better way to get girls than by being Mr. Supersweetie clean-cut boy-band guy?

M: Jared is not a superpredator! He's taking me to dinner!

D: You'll be the main course.

M: D!

D: Have fun riding in his trunk.

M: D!!

D: Macy, I'm just looking out for you, is all.

M: What are you, my mom?

D: You're mom can't be around 24-7, Macy. But I can. Look…how long have we been living together?

M: For…for as long as I can remember.

D: And we've talked about this. About you needing a man to justify your existence? You're *enough*, Macy. You don't need a man.

M: But I *want* a man! This one!

D: He wants your liver. With some fava beans and a nice chianti.

M: D!!!

D: We've discussed this. You valuing you for *you*, not for what others see in you. Working on yourself. Learning how to be alone. Look at me. *[D grapes Macy by the shoulders.] Look at me*, Macy. If he cares about you…if he *truly* cares about you…he'll be willing to wait, right? He'll be willing to work for it?

M: I…I suppose…

D: You don't need to dive into this thing face-first, like some starry-eyed schoolgirl. You're the cool girl, Macy. You're self-sufficient. You are a strong black woman who don't need no man!

M: I'm not black, D.

D: Metaphorically, I mean. *[Pause]* Play it cool, Macy. Make him wait. You know I'm right about this.

M: I mean...I *guess*...

D: Stay in with me tonight. We'll watch *Dragonseed* on Netflix.

M: I don't...I don't *want*...

D: Sure you do. Fools rush in. Be smart. Stay safe. Make him work.

M: All...all right, D. All right. I'll tell him no. We'll stay in and watch Netflix.

D: Attagirl. Proud of you, Macy.

M: Yeah. Sure, D. Sure.

[SCENE]

[*D and Macy are sitting on the couch, staring numbly into the distance. Macy stands.*]

D: Where ya goin'?

M: Out.

D: *[Without looking up]* Spider.

M: What?

D: Over there by the door.

M: Ew!

D: Biiiig spider.

[A long pause.]

M: Maybe if I...just sorta slowly scootch past it...

D: It's reeeeeally pretty close to the door, Macy.

M: Ew. Ew.

D: Yep. *[pause]* Wanna stare at the wall some more?

M: Yeah. Sure. Okay.

D: Attagirl.

[SCENE]

D: So this is how it is, huh, Macy? I let you leave the apartment, and you come back, and you bring drugs into our home.

M: They're not drugs, D. I have a prescription.

D: From that quack Dr. Schwartz. They're drugs, Macy. After all we've been through together, you've decided you can't stand up on your own two feet, and you're going to become dependent on drugs.

M: They're just pills.

D: Give me those.

[Macy hands her a vial of pills. D reads the label.]

D: "Buproprion. 10 milligrams. Take once daily, for...depression."

[A long pause. D stares Macy down.]

D: For D-pression. You're trying to get rid of me.

M: I...just need you to be a little quieter for a while.

D: You want me gone.

M: What I want, D, is...

D: All I've done for you, and you...

M: YES! GODDAMNIT, D! I WANT YOU GONE! BECAUSE YOU SUCK!

[A long pause]

D: Uh...rude!

M: Never a moment's peace, for years! All the excuses, D! All the opportunities I've lost, because you wouldn't let me leave the apartment! Because I had cramps! Because of climate change! Because there might be a guy hiding under my car with a razor blade, waiting to slash my ankle!

D: I'm trying to keep you safe, Macy.

M: I can't live my life wrapped in bubble wrap! I have to get out there, D! Not every night, but at least *some of the time!* I need to have a life! I need to have fun!

D: We have fun.

M: We have *numb*, D. Numb is not fun! I'm tired of living under anesthesia!

D: Beats the hell out of getting hurt.

M: NO! IT DOESN'T! Life is pain! And pleasure! And sorrow! And joy! And frustration, and passion, and confusion, and...all the other shuns! I WANT A LIFE! Bitter, and sweet, and wonderful, and horrible! I want it all! A ship in harbor is safe, D. But that's not what ships are for!

D: You stole that from somebody.

M: It's a quote from John A. Shedd.

D: Christ. I knew letting you go to English class was a mistake.

M: You don't LET me *anything*, D. You don't have a say. Not anymore. I'm gonna take a pill...

D: Druggie.

M: ...and I'm gonna head out that door, and I'm gonna leave you behind.

D: You're not gonna leave me behind, Macy. Because I am you.

M: You're not me, D.

D: I AM YOU, Macy Jane McAllister. I am the harsh truths you refuse to face, I am the only sensible instincts you possess, and I am the face you have been showing the world since you were eleven years old. I'm the you Jared cares about. Will he still care when I'm gone? Who would you even be, without me?

M: I don't know. I honestly don't know, D. But I'm ready to find out.

D: I'm not leaving. You know that, right? You might push me back for a while with a pill, but you and I will always be roommates. I'm not leaving.

M: Maybe you're not. But I am. [*She heads for the door*]

D: Don't you dare, Macy. Don't you dare walk out that door. I swear to God, you'll regret it.

M: Maybe. But I'm going.

[She takes a deep breath, turns the knob, and steps through the door. As she does, D fades into the background. Macy exhales slowly, a massive weight having been lifted]

M: Attagirl.